

Solution #6: Modem Power Supplies

You should only use the power supply provided with your modem. Even though other power supplies might work, they may cause the modem to act erratically, resulting in slow speeds or disconnection.

Solution #7: Modem Error Correction

High data speeds require an error correcting modem. Ensure your modem has this feature enabled/turned on (usually found in the Control Panel under Modems).

► **Problem:** Your 56K modem connects at 33.6 or less.

Cause: There are several causes for this.

Solution: Some Internet service providers have separate phone numbers for 56K. Make sure you're calling the right number. Next, if there is a telephone, answering machine, etc., plugged into the back of the modem, unplug it. The modem is supposed to ignore devices plugged into it when it is online, but that is not always the case. Also try disconnecting additional telephony devices (fax, phones, answering machines, etc.) from the phone line, even if they're in a different room. Try running the phone line directly from the back of the modem to the wall, without passing through surge suppressors, splitters, phone line extenders, etc.

It's always a good idea to check the firmware and drivers page for your modem to see if there is a more recent version available. Many people's problems disappear once they installed a new version of the driver or firmware.

► **Problem:** You cannot get PPPoE in XP to log in automatically at bootup.

Solution: Open Network Connections in the Control Panel, right-click on your connection icon, and select Properties. Uncheck "Prompt for name and password..." and click OK. Now go to C:\Documents and Settings\All Users\Start Menu\Programs. Here, add a shortcut to your PPPoE connection.

► **Problem:** A prompt to shut down the Internet connection comes up when you switch users in Windows XP.